

✦ Tableau Dashboards – Notes

✦ 1. What is a Dashboard?

A dashboard in Tableau is a collection of multiple worksheets or visualizations displayed together in a single view.

A dashboard helps users:

- View multiple charts at the same time.
- Compare different aspects of data.
- Interact with filters and charts.
- Monitor important KPIs (Key Performance Indicators).
- Present data in an easy-to-understand format.

Example: A sales dashboard may contain:

- Total Sales KPI
- Sales by Region
- Monthly Sales Trend
- Top 10 Products
- Sales by Category

✦ 2. Main Components of a Tableau Dashboard

Worksheets

Individual charts or visualizations created in Tableau.

Dashboard

A canvas where multiple worksheets are arranged together.

Filters

Allow users to display only the required data.

allow users to display only the required data.

Legends

Explain colors, shapes, or sizes used in a visualization.

Parameters

Allow users to dynamically change certain values or calculations.

Dashboard Objects

Objects that can be added to a dashboard include:

- Text
- Images
- Web pages
- Blank spaces
- Navigation buttons
- Worksheets

✦ 3. Types of Dashboard Layouts

Tableau provides two main layout approaches:

Tiled

Objects are arranged in a grid-like structure. They automatically fit together.

Floating

Objects can be placed freely on top of other objects and positioned precisely.

✦ 4. Simple Steps to Create a Dashboard

1. Create the required worksheets.
2. Click **New Dashboard**.

3. Select the required dashboard size.
 4. Drag worksheets onto the dashboard.
 5. Arrange and resize the charts.
 6. Add filters and legends.
 7. Add titles, text, or images if required.
 8. Add interactivity such as filter actions.
 9. Format the dashboard.
 10. Save or publish the dashboard.
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✦ Exporting a Tableau Visualization

Tableau allows visualizations and dashboards to be exported in several formats.

1. Export as Image

Useful when you need a picture of a chart or dashboard.

Basic process: Worksheet/Dashboard → Export → Image

The visualization can then be saved as an image file.

2. Export as PDF

Useful for reports and printing.

Basic process: Dashboard → Export → PDF

The dashboard can be saved as a PDF document.

3. Export Data

You can export the underlying or summarized data for further analysis.

Depending on the Tableau environment, data can be exported to formats such as:

- CSV
- Excel
- Crosstab

4. Export PowerPoint

Tableau can also provide dashboard content for use in PowerPoint presentations, depending on the Tableau product/version and available permissions.

✦ Sharing a Tableau Visualization

Tableau provides several ways to share visualizations.

1. Tableau Server

Organizations can publish dashboards to **Tableau Server**.

Users with appropriate permissions can:

- View dashboards
- Interact with filters
- Share dashboards
- Collaborate with other users

2. Tableau Cloud

Dashboards can be published to Tableau Cloud and accessed through a web browser by authorized users.

3. Tableau Public

Visualizations can be published publicly through **Tableau Public**.

Important: Tableau Public is intended for public sharing, so it should not be used for confidential or sensitive business data.

4. Share Link

A published visualization can be shared using its URL, provided the recipient has the necessary access.

5. Embed Visualization

A Tableau visualization can be embedded into supported websites or applications, subject to the appropriate Tableau setup and permissions.

✦ Export vs Sharing

Export	Sharing
Creates a copy/file of the visualization or data	Gives other users access to the visualization
PDF, image, CSV, Excel, etc.	Tableau Server, Tableau Cloud, Tableau Public
Useful for reports and offline use	Useful for interactive analysis
Usually loses some interactivity	Can retain filters and interactions

Quick Revision

Dashboard: Collection of multiple visualizations in one view.

Export: Save visualization/data in another format such as PDF, image, CSV, or Excel.

Sharing: Make a visualization available to other users through Tableau Server, Tableau Cloud, Tableau Public, links, or embedding.